



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Tweeting your thoughts is fun!



Learning Outcome

Describe necessity, duty, advice, or strong disapproval in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technology and personal dilemmas.
- I can explain the sequence of events.
- I can express possible future events.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you tweet or receive tweets?
- Who do you think has the highest number of followers on Twitter?

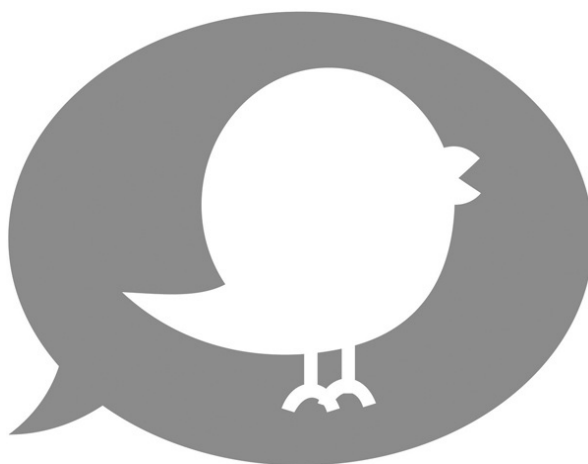




Let's Explore!

You get **the gist***!

* "The gist" is the general idea.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

If you should happen to have something to say, you want to tell everyone, right? If they happen to retweet, thank them, right? If they don't happen to be interested in the minutiae of your life every 10 minutes, they should stop following you, right? So if they should happen to hang on your every word, tweet them well.

If you don't happen to be interested in Twitter, stop here.

I do follow Twitter. I spend time gleaning tweets for scoops or enlightenment on things less talked about. I deduce, garner, extract what I can and move on. I don't follow the power users. I myself have an account, but rarely speak. If I did, it would go something like this:

5:00 a.m. Sitting under my Sad Light Therapy lamp. I wasn't going to complain but the sun won't be back this early for months!

6:00 a.m. Couldn't get the first streetcar because I was standing in line for coffee.

6:30 a.m. Subway decided it would hold us hostage for an extra half hour today.

7:20 a.m. Commute was so slow I would have been better off walking!

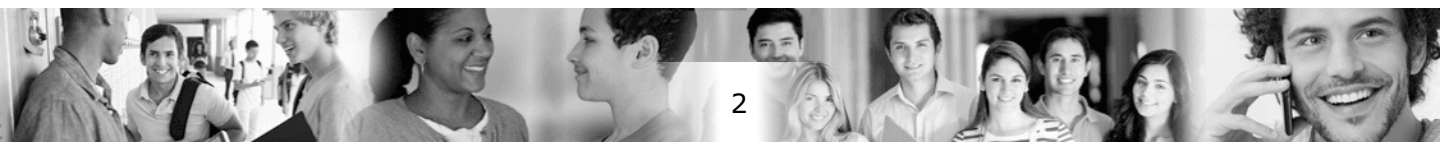
7:40 a.m. It was announced that the servers would be down all day and we should work from home.

7:50 a.m. I heard on my way out that we were all to be moved to a new office space in a week. Ummm ...

8:30 a.m. Was about to leave the office when I was sidetracked by my boss wanting to chat ...

9:30 a.m. Texts were sent out to all of us to come back to the office - crashed server back online ...

10:00 a.m. Missed the streetcar because I was standing in line for coffee ...



**Let's Practice!**

Don't you hate it when you're getting ready to leave and your boss asks you to do something else?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Rewrite the sentences correctly.

1. sun won't / for months. / I wasn't / be back / complain, / this early / but the / going to

2. Commute was / walking! / have been / I would / so slow, / better off

3. be moved / out that / office space / on my way / all to / I heard / we were / to a new / in a / week.

**Let's Practice!**

Are you an active Twitter user?

Instructions: Use the Words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

following / gleaning tweets / servers / scoops /
the power users / chat / sidetracked / have an account

- 1) They should stop _____ you if they are not interested in what you post.
- 2) I do follow Twitter. I spend time _____ for _____ or enlightenment on things less talked about.
- 3) I don't follow _____. I myself _____, but rarely speak.
- 4) It was announced that the _____ would be down all day and we should work from home.
- 5) I was about to leave the office when I was _____ by my boss wanting to _____.





Extension Activity

Look at Twitter quotes.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find a site with Twitter quotes you are interested in reading in English.
- Go through 25 or 30 of them.
- How many quotes do you find interesting and how many do you find banal?
- Write 10 things that you would tweet. Type them up a sheet to post in the classroom.
- Post your tweets and read what others have posted. Are there any themes?
- Discuss your ideas on what you have read with a partner.



Target Words

- minutiae** (noun): small, unimportant details
e.g. If they don't happen to be interested in the minutiae of your life every 10 minutes, they should stop following you right?
- to retweet** (verb): to repost or forward a message posted by another user
e.g. If they happen to retweet, thank them, right?
- Twitter** (noun): an online social networking service that enables users to send and read short messages
e.g. I do follow Twitter.
- to glean** (verb): to collect information in small amounts, often with difficulty
e.g. I spend time gleaning tweets for scoops or enlightenment on things less talked about.
- power user** (noun): experienced, frequent users
e.g. I don't follow the power users.
- enlightenment** (noun): understanding
e.g. I spend time gleaning tweets for scoops or enlightenment on things less talked about.
- server** (noun): a central computer from which other computers get information
e.g. It was announced that the servers would be down all day and we should work from home.
- to crash** (verb): fail; stop working properly
e.g. Texts were sent out to all of us to come back to the office - crashed server back online.
- to garner** (verb): to collect something, usually after much work or with difficulty
e.g. I deduce, garner, extract what I can and move on.
- to deduce** (verb): to arrive at a fact or conclusion by reasoning
e.g. I deduce, garner, extract what I can and move on.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I read through Twitter quotes online taking note of which are interesting and which are banal.

☐ ☐

I type up my own 10 tweets with 140 characters on a sheet.

☐ ☐

I post my tweets in the class.

☐ ☐

I read the other tweet sheets.

☐ ☐

I note whether there are themes running through the tweets.

☐ ☐

I discuss what I have read with another student.

☐ ☐



Learning Points

The Future Seen from the Past

You can talk about an event that was in the future at a particular point in the past. You use the past tenses of the verb forms you would normally use to talk about the future.

You can express the future as a future event seen from now, or as a future event supposed to happen at a certain point in the past.

Compare the following forms of the future.

Future from Now	Future from the Past
<i>I'll stay at home this summer.</i>	<i>She decided that she would stay at home for the summer.</i>
<i>I'm not going to say anything about the Christmas presents.</i>	<i>I wasn't going to say anything, but the kids asked me yesterday.</i>
<i>I'm having a meeting with my boss later.</i>	<i>John said he was having a meeting with his boss in the afternoon.</i>
<i>The party will have been over by midnight.</i>	<i>He said the party would have been over by midnight.</i>

Examples:

- I wasn't going to complain but the sun won't be back this early for months!*
- I couldn't get the first streetcar because I was standing in line for coffee.*
- The subway decided it would hold us hostage for an extra half hour today.*
- The commute was so slow I would have been better off walking!*
- It was announced that the servers would be down all day and we should work from home.*





Learning Points

Real Conditional: Expressing Possible Future Events

You use the Real Conditional with *If* clauses to exchange opinions about possible future outcomes.

You use the Real Conditional to say it's possible that you will or will not do something. In that condition, something else may, may not, will, or will not happen.

The parts of the sentence are divided into two clauses: the *If* clause and the *Condition* clause.

You use *if ... happen to*, or *if ... should happen to* to express an outcome that may be possible, but not very likely.

Examples:

- *If you should happen to have something to say, you want to tell everyone, right?*
- *If they happen to retweet, thank them, right?*
- *If they don't happen to be interested in the minutiae of your life every 10 minutes, they should stop following you right?*
- *So if they should happen to hang on your every word, tweet them well.*
- *If you don't happen to be interested in Twitter, stop here.*

